

doc-christ-sole-mediator

Affirms · Christology › Mediation · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · Brethren distinctive · confidence: high

Statement under examination

Christ is the sole mediator between God and humanity (1 Tim 2:5; Heb 7:25; John 14:6); access to God is not mediated by any other figure.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical demonstration. 1 Tim 2:5 uses εἷς heis G1520 doubled (one God, one mediator) with μεσίτης mesitēs G3316 as the single go-between between θεοῦ theou and ἀνθρώπων anthrōpōn, identified as ἄνθρωπος Χριστὸς Ἰησοῦς. John 14:6 employs ἐγώ εἰμι plus the triple definite-article construction (ἡ ὁδὸς hē hodos G3598, ἡ ἀλήθεια hē alētheia G225, ἡ ζωὴ hē zōē G2222) with the exclusivity formula οὐδεὶς ἔρχεται πρὸς τὸν πατέρα εἰ μὴ δι' ἐμοῦ (no one comes to the Father except through me), stacking the negation οὐδεὶς G3762 with the exception particle εἰ μὴ εἰ μὴ for absolute exclusion. Acts 4:12 piles three negations (οὐκ G3756, οὐδενὶ G3762, οὐδὲ G3761) with ἕτερον heteron G2087 to deny that salvation exists in any other name. Heb 8:6, 9:15, and 12:24 designate Christ μεσίτης of the new covenant, the technical covenant-broker word. Heb 7:25 uses ἐντυχάνω entunchanō G1793 (to intercede) with πάντοτε ζῶν 'always living' to ground the permanence of that intercession. 1 John 2:1 calls Christ παράκλητον paraklēton G3875 πρὸς τὸν πατέρα 'advocate with the Father'. Six occurrences of μεσίτης, all six identify a single mediator: Christ as new-covenant broker; Moses by contrast functions as a mediator only of a covenant Paul shows to be inferior and provisional (Gal 3:19-20).

Reasoning

Verdict: Christ is the only mediator between God and humanity. No other figure mediates access to God in his place. The strongest reason from Scripture is the way 1 Timothy 2:5 doubles the word 'one'. It says 'there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus.' The Greek piles up exclusivity: one God, one go-between, one human qualified to do it. John 14:6 stacks the claim further. Jesus says 'I am the way, and the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.' The Greek combines two negations to lock the door tightly. Acts 4:12 piles three negations into one sentence: 'there is salvation in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved.' Hebrews calls Christ the mediator of a new covenant in three different places (Hebrews 8:6, 9:15, 12:24), and Hebrews 7:25 says he 'always lives to make intercession' for those who come to God through him. 1 John 2:1 calls Christ our 'advocate with the Father.' Add it all up and the New Testament tells the same story six different ways. The strongest counterargument inside the Bible is the picture of other people praying for one another. Paul asks the Roman church to pray for him in Romans 15:30. James 5:16 says 'pray for one another, that you may be healed.' Hebrews 7:25 itself is set inside a passage where Christ's intercession is praised, but Romans 8:26 says the Holy Spirit also intercedes for the saints. If the Spirit and other believers can intercede, why not departed Christians too. The verdict handles this tension by drawing a careful distinction the Bible itself draws. Praying for someone (asking God on their behalf) is a normal Christian act and is commanded. Mediating between God and humanity (standing in the gap so that access to God depends on you) is something only Christ does. Romans 8:34 and Hebrews 7:25 ground that mediation in Christ's death, resurrection, and present session at God's right hand, things no creature can do. The Spirit's intercession in Romans 8:26 is the work of God himself, not a creaturely mediation. Christians disagree about this. Most Christian traditions (Lutheran, Anglican, Reformed, Methodist, Anabaptist, Pentecostal) hold that asking departed saints to intercede goes beyond what Scripture warrants and effectively places another figure between us and God. Catholic and Eastern Orthodox traditions also affirm that Christ is the unique mediator, but they teach that Mary and the saints

participate in a subordinate, derived way that draws all its meaning from Christ's mediation. Outright denial of Christ as the only saving mediator (such as teachings that all religions equally lead to God, or that other named figures share his saving role) lies outside historic Christianity in every lineage.

Denominational landscape

Every major historic Christian lineage formally affirms that Christ is the unique mediator between God and humanity; lineages divide sharply on whether Mary and the saints participate in a derived, subordinate way. Patristic witness: Augustine in City of God Book 9 teaches that humans 'need not many but one Mediator, the uncreated Word of God,' uniquely qualified because he is both God and man. Catholic magisterial teaching: the Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraph 970 states explicitly that Mary's role 'in no way obscures or diminishes this unique mediation of Christ, but rather shows its power.' The Catechism does call Mary 'Advocate, Helper, Benefactress, and Mediatrix' but situates these titles as participation in Christ's one mediation, not as parallel or independent mediation. Lutheran: Augsburg Confession Article XXI rejects invocation of saints and confesses that 'Scripture teaches not the invocation of saints or to ask help of saints, since it sets before us the one Christ as the Mediator.' Anglican: Article XXII of the 39 Articles classifies invocation of saints as 'a fond thing, vainly invented, and grounded upon no warrant of Scripture, but repugnant to the Word of God.' Reformed: Westminster Confession 8.1 confesses Christ as the only Mediator between God and man. Methodist: United Methodist Article XIV repeats the Anglican rejection of invocation of saints in identical terms. Anabaptist: the Dordrecht and Schleithem Anabaptist tradition prays only through Christ. Pentecostal: Assemblies of God doctrine confesses salvation only through faith in Jesus Christ, with no provision for invocation of saints. Eastern Orthodox: the Orthodox tradition teaches Christ as the unique high priest and mediator of the new covenant while practicing intercession through the saints and especially the Theotokos (Mary), framed as the prayers of fellow members of the body of Christ rather than as a parallel mediation. Public-record carriers of outright denial of Christ's unique saving mediation fall outside historic Christianity. Religious pluralism, the teaching that all religions equally lead to God, denies the exclusivity language of John 14:6 and Acts 4:12. Iglesia ni Cristo founded by Felix Manalo denies the deity of Christ and therefore his mediation as God-man. Christian Science as taught by Mary Baker Eddy reframes Christ as a principle rather than a mediating person. Mormonism teaches additional mediating figures and a restored priesthood held by Mormon men. Hard Universalism denies the necessity of conscious faith in Christ's mediation. Within historic Christianity, the Catholic and Orthodox practice of asking saints to pray is rejected by Protestant lineages as going beyond Scripture, but the Protestant tradition has historically classified it as serious error within Christianity rather than as a cult-grade denial of the gospel.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Cult-marker-if-denied=true is scoped carefully. The canonical demonstration is strong: 1 Tim 2:5, John 14:6, Acts 4:12, and the cluster of μεσίτης occurrences in Hebrews together state in unambiguous lexical form that Christ alone mediates the new covenant and that salvation is found in no other name. Outright denial constitutes denial of the gospel and is gospel-stake territory. Public-record carriers of outright denial: religious pluralism (the proposition that all religions lead to God; this denies the εἰ μὴ exclusivity of John 14:6 and the heteron-exclusion of Acts 4:12), Universalism in its hard form, Iglesia ni Cristo (which denies the unique mediatorship of Christ as God-man), classical Mormon teaching about additional mediators and the Aaronic / Melchizedek priesthoods being held by Mormon men, certain New Age formulations of Christ as one ascended master among many. The HARD case is intra-Christian: Catholic and Eastern Orthodox traditions both formally affirm Christ as the unique mediator (CCC 970 explicitly: Mary's function in no way obscures or diminishes this unique mediation of Christ) while teaching that Mary and the saints exercise a derived, subordinate, participatory intercession. Protestants (Lutheran AC XXI, Anglican Article XXII, Reformed WCF, Methodist Article XIV, Pentecostal, Anabaptist) flatly reject invocation of saints as repugnant to Scripture. The lexical-canonical question 'does any creature mediate alongside Christ' the apparatus answers no. The polemic question 'is Catholic / Orthodox invocation of saints cult-grade error or heterodox-but-Christian error' the apparatus does not settle; this is where confessional traditions diverge and the present rubric flags it for the reader without classifying Catholicism or Orthodoxy as cults. Fruit-vs-precision: most Catholic and Orthodox laypeople pray to Christ as their savior and ask saints to pray for them in the same logical structure they ask living friends to pray for them. The apostolic-era language of asking departed saints to intercede is not in the canon, but the underlying request (intercession) is. Verdict-scope summary: full denial of Christ's unique saving mediation (pluralism, Universalism, additional Mediator-equals-Christ teaching) is cult-marker territory; subordinate-saints-intercession views within Catholic and Orthodox tradition are heterodox by Protestant lights but ecumenically treated as in-house Christian disagreement, not cult-grade.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Is there one mediator between God and humanity, and if so, who? Does Scripture present access to God as mediated through any figure other than Christ?

Notes. The statement 'Christ is the sole mediator between God and humanity... access to God is not mediated by any other figure' asserts the verdict. However, the assertion is the direct content of 1 Tim 2:5 (heis kai mesites theou kai anthropon) and is rendered in lexical terms native to the apostolic text, not in Reformed-scholastic vocabulary. The phrase 'access to God' echoes the prosagogen / parrhesia language of Eph 2:18 and Heb 4:16. No confessional loading detected (terms like 'imputed righteousness' or 'penal substitution' would have indicated Reformed loading; they are absent). Working the neutralized form yields the same verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. protestant_sola_christi, catholic_subordinate_mediation, eastern_orthodox_communion_of_saints, religious_pluralism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

· affirms:

· affirms:

· affirms:

· denies:

The verdict rests on the concordance pattern of μεσίτης G3316 (six NT occurrences, five identifying Christ as mediator of the new covenant and one identifying Moses as mediator of the inferior covenant), the parakletos G3875 pattern (one occurrence of Christ as advocate, four of the Spirit), and the entunchanō G1793 pattern (Christ at Heb 7:25 and Rom 8:34, the Spirit at Rom 8:27). Analogia scripturae is invoked to distinguish covenant-mediation (mesitēs, reserved for Christ) from intercession-as-action (enteuxis / deēsis, performed by Christ, the Spirit, and the church for one another). Progressive revelation operates between Moses-as-mediator-of-the-law and Christ-as-mediator-of-the-new-covenant: the typological pattern is fulfilled in Hebrews. The grammatico-historical method with the canonical accommodation principle suffices for the verdict; no esoteric or dispensational reading is required.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. εἷς γὰρ θεός εἷς καὶ μεσίτης θεοῦ καὶ ἀνθρώπων ἄνθρωπος Χριστὸς Ἰησοῦς; heis G1520 doubled; mesitēs G3316 N-NMS

Force. mesitēs = go-between, internunciator, reconciler. The numeric adjective heis ('one') is repeated and matched: one God, one mediator. The single mediator is identified as ἄνθρωπος Χριστὸς Ἰησοῦς, the man Christ Jesus, grounding the mediation in his incarnate humanity. The verse is the locus classicus and lexically explicit

John.14.6 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐγὼ εἰμι ἡ ὁδὸς καὶ ἡ ἀλήθεια καὶ ἡ ζωὴ; οὐδεὶς ἔρχεται πρὸς τὸν πατέρα εἰ μὴ δι' ἐμοῦ; hodos G3598; alētheia G225; zōē G2222; oudeis G3762; ei mē G1487+G3361

Force. Triple definite-article identification (the way, the truth, the life) with absolute ἐγὼ εἰμι. The exclusivity clause stacks οὐδεὶς ('no one') with εἰ μὴ ('except'), the strongest Greek construction for absolute exclusion. The preposition διὰ with genitive ἐμοῦ marks Christ as the unique channel of access to the Father

Acts.4.12 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν ἄλλῳ οὐδενὶ ἢ σωτηρία οὐδὲ γὰρ ὄνομά ἐστιν ἕτερον; sōtēria G4991; onoma G3686; heteros G2087; triple negation ouk G3756 plusouden G3762 plus oude G3761

Force. Peter to the Sanhedrin. Three negations piled with the discriminating word heteron ('different in kind, other'). 'Salvation is in no one else, for there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved.' Lexically the strongest exclusive-mediator statement in Acts

Heb.9.15 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. διαθήκης καινῆς μεσίτης ἐστίν; mesitēs G3316 N-NMS; diathēkē G1242; kainos G2537

Force. Christ is identified as the mesitēs of the new covenant (διαθήκης καινῆς), the technical covenant-broker term. The verse links his mediation to his death, which secures redemption from transgressions under the first covenant and grants the called the promised eternal inheritance. Mediation here is concretely soteriological

Heb.7.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πάντοτε ζῶν εἰς τὸ ἐντυγχάνειν ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν; entunchanō G1793 present infinitive active; pantelēs G3838

Force. entunchanō = to intercede, plead on behalf of. The present infinitive with πάντοτε ζῶν ('always living') grounds the permanence of the intercession in Christ's indestructible life (v.16). The result clause uses πάντελες ('completely, to the uttermost') for the totality of the salvation secured. Mediation is not a one-time act but a continuous priestly office

Heb.12.24 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. διαθήκης νέας μεσίτη Ἰησοῦ; mesitēs G3316 N-DMS; diathēkē G1242; neos G3501

Force. Concordance reinforcement of Heb 8:6 and 9:15. Jesus identified as the mediator of a new covenant, contrasted with the mediation at Sinai under Moses (vv.18-21). The exodus paradigm is preserved but transposed: Christ replaces Moses as the covenant go-between, and his sprinkled blood speaks better than the blood of Abel

Heb.8.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. κρείττονός ἐστιν διαθήκης μεσίτης; mesitēs G3316 N-NMS; kreittōn G2909

Force. Christ is the mediator of a better (κρείττονος) covenant established on better promises. Concordance reinforcement: every NT use of mesitēs in Hebrews (8:6, 9:15, 12:24) identifies Christ as the single mediator of the new covenant. The author has no other candidate in view

1John.2.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. παράκλητον ἔχομεν πρὸς τὸν πατέρα Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν δίκαιον; paraklētos G3875 N-AMS; dikaios G1342

Force. paraklētos = one called alongside, advocate, legal counsel. Christ identified as our advocate πρὸς τὸν πατέρα ('with the Father'). The qualifier δίκαιον ('righteous') establishes his moral standing to plead. v.2 grounds the advocacy in his propitiatory work (hilasmos G2434). Mediation in courtroom-legal terms

Rom.8.34 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. Χριστὸς Ἰησοῦς ὁ ἀποθανὼν μᾶλλον δὲ ἐγερθεὶς ὃς καὶ ἐστὶν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ θεοῦ ὃς καὶ ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν; entunchanō G1793 present active indicative 3s

Force. Four-fold ground of Christ's mediating work: died, raised, seated at God's right hand, presently interceding. The present indicative entunchanei makes the intercession ongoing, not past. Linked to the unbreakable chain of Romans 8:29-39 in which no creature can separate us from God's love in Christ Jesus

John.14.16 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. ἄλλον παράκλητον; allos G243; paraklētos G3875

Force. Jesus promises to send 'another (allos = another of the same kind) paraklētos', the Holy Spirit. The lexical implication is that Jesus himself is the first paraklētos and the Spirit is the second of the same kind, both functioning as advocates. Concordance: paraklētos is used five times, four of the Spirit and one (1 John 2:1) of Christ. Mediation is shared in role with the Spirit but only Christ mediates the covenant

Rom.8.27 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. τὸ φρόνημα τοῦ πνεύματος ὅτι κατὰ θεὸν ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἁγίων; entunchanō G1793 present active 3s

Force. The Spirit intercedes for the saints. Same verb as Christ's intercession in Heb 7:25 and Rom 8:34. The lexical evidence shows that intercession (entunchanein) is performed by both Christ and the Spirit, but covenant mediation (mesitēs) is reserved for Christ alone. Distinction between intercession-as-action and mediation-as-covenantal-office

Rom.8.26 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμα ὑπερεντυγχάνει στεναγμοῖς ἀλαλήτοις; hyperentunchanō G5241 present active 3s

Force. hyperentunchanō = to intercede on behalf of (intensified form). The Spirit's intercession with wordless groanings. The action is intercessory but the Spirit is not a created creature inserted between humans and God; the Spirit is God himself making intercession from within the believer. Mediation here is intra-Trinitarian, not creaturely-additional

Gal.3.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. διαταγείς δι' ἀγγέλων ἐν χειρὶ μεσίτου; mesitēs G3316 N-GMS; angelos G32

Force. Paul says the law was ordained 'through angels by the hand of a mediator', referring to Moses at Sinai. Concordance: the only non-Christ use of mesitēs in the NT is Moses, and the rhetorical point of Galatians 3:19-20 is that the mediated-law arrangement is inferior to God's direct promise to Abraham. v.20 'a mediator implies more than one' tightens the argument: the singular new-covenant Mediator is the eschatological replacement

Gal.3.20 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ὁ δὲ μεσίτης ἑνὸς οὐκ ἔστιν ὁ δὲ θεὸς εἷς ἔστιν; mesitēs G3316; heis G1520

Force. 'A mediator is not for one party; but God is one.' Lexically dense. Paul argues that the Sinai mediation involves two parties (God and Israel through Moses and angels), while the Abrahamic promise was direct and one-sided. The eis heis pattern foreshadows 1 Tim 2:5 heis kai mesitēs: in Christ, the one God and the one humanity meet in one person

Eph.2.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. δι' αὐτοῦ ἔχομεν τὴν προσαγωγὴν οἱ ἀμφότεροι ἐν ἐνὶ πνεύματι πρὸς τὸν πατέρα; prosagōgē G4318

Force. prosagōgē = access, introduction (as to a ruler). Through Christ both Jew and Gentile have access in one Spirit to the Father. Trinitarian access-structure: through (dia) the Son, in (en) the Spirit, to (pros) the Father. The dia is exclusive; Christ is the channel, not one of several

Heb.4.16 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key term. προσερχώμεθα οὖν μετὰ παρρησίας τῷ θρόνῳ τῆς χάριτος; parresia G3954; proserchomai G4334

Force. parresia = boldness, freedom of speech (etymologically 'all-speech'). Believers approach the throne of grace directly because Christ is the high priest who has passed through the heavens. The bold-access language depends entirely on Christ's high-priestly mediation (vv.14-15). No other intermediary is named or required

Deut.5.5 · **for** · genre: law · figures: typology

Key term. אָמַד אֶת־בֵּין יְהוָה וְיָמִין דְּמַעַי יִכְנָא; amad H5975 qal active participle; ben H996 doubled

Force. Moses says 'I stood between the LORD and you at that time, to declare to you the word of the LORD.' The lexical structure ben...uben (between...and between) is the OT analog to mesos / mesitēs. Concordance: Moses as the OT mediator-pattern fulfilled and superseded by Christ (Heb 3:1-6, 8:6, 9:15). Typological foundation for the Christ-mediator argument

Job.9.33 · **for** · genre: wisdom

Key term. מֹכִיָּאֵךְ יֵשׁ לֵבָי וְנִיבִיבִי שִׁי־אֵל; mokiach H3198 hiphil active participle; lo yesh H3808+H3426

Force. mokiach = arbiter, umpire, reprover. Job laments 'there is no arbiter between us, who might lay his hand on us both.' The lexical lack in OT (no qualified divine-human umpire) sets up the NT fulfillment in Christ who is both God and man. Heb 7:26-28 answers Job's lament with the qualified mediator-priest

1Tim.2.1 · **complicates** · genre: epistle

Key term. δεήσεις προσευχὰς ἐντεύξεις εὐχαριστίας ὑπὲρ πάντων ἀνθρώπων; enteuxis G1783

Force. enteuxis = petition, intercession (cognate noun of entunchanō). Paul commands Christians to make intercessions for all people. Lexical evidence: human intercession for others is commanded as a normal Christian act. The verse SETS UP 1 Tim 2:5: human intercession occurs through the one mediator, not as parallel mediation. Distinction between praying-for-others (commanded for all believers) and mediating-the-covenant (Christ alone)

Jas.5.16 · **complicates** · genre: epistle

Key term. εὐχεσθε ὑπὲρ ἀλλήλων ὅπως ἰαθῆτε πολὺ ἰσχύει δέησις δικαίου ἐνεργουμένη; deēsis G1162; dikaios G1342

Force. 'Pray for one another, that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous person is powerful in its effect.' Living believers praying for one another is commanded. The verse does not authorize prayer to or through departed saints; it commands mutual horizontal intercession among the living. Frequently cited in confessional debates about communion-of-saints intercession

Rev.5.8 · **complicates** · genre: apocalyptic · figures: apocalyptic-symbolism

Key term. ἔχοντες ἕκαστος κιθάραν καὶ φιάλας χρυσᾶς γεμούσας θυμιαμάτων αἱ εἰσὶν αἱ προσευχαὶ τῶν ἁγίων; proseuchē G4335; thymiama G2368

Force. The twenty-four elders hold golden bowls of incense which are the prayers of the saints (αἱ προσευχαὶ τῶν ἁγίων). Apocalyptic-symbolic image. Cited in Catholic/Orthodox tradition as canonical warrant for the prayers of departed saints being presented to God. Read with the wider Apocalypse, the elders are intermediary worship-figures, not redemptive mediators. Distinction between liturgical-presentation and covenantal mediation is preserved

Concordance lemmas traversed

G3316, G3875, G1793, G5241, G1783, G1162, G4335, G2434, G1520, G3762, G3756, G3761, G2087, G3686, G4991, G3598, G225, G2222, G243, G3838, G2909, G2537, G3501, G1242, G4318, G3954, G4334, G2368, H5975,

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Augustine, City of God Book 9 Chapter 15 (CCEL NPNF Series 1 Vol 2); cited at <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/npnf102/npnf102.iv.IX.15.html> · affirms · verified

“Augustine: ‘we need not many but one Mediator, the uncreated Word of God, by whom all things were made, and in partaking of whom we are blessed.’ Christ uniquely qualified as both God and man; his mediation is exclusive in number”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 969-970 (Lumen Gentium 62 quoted) · affirms · verified

“CCC 969-970: ‘The Blessed Virgin is invoked in the Church under the titles of Advocate, Helper, Benefactress, and Mediatrix... Mary’s function in no way obscures or diminishes this unique mediation of Christ, but rather shows its power.’ Subordinate participatory mediation, not parallel”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Article XXI, Of the Worship of the Saints (bookofconcord.org) · affirms · verified

“AC XXI: ‘Scripture teaches not the invocation of saints or to ask help of saints, since it sets before us the one Christ as the Mediator, Propitiation, High Priest, and Intercessor.’ Numeric exclusivity from 1 Tim 2:5 applied directly”

anglican · 39 Articles of Religion, Article XXII, Of Purgatory (churchofengland.org) · affirms · unverified

“Article XXII: ‘The Romish Doctrine concerning... Invocation of Saints, is a fond thing, vainly invented, and grounded upon no warrant of Scripture, but rather repugnant to the Word of God.’ Invocation of saints rejected as unscriptural”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith 8.1 (Of Christ the Mediator); Heidelberg Catechism Q.30 · affirms · unverified

“WCF 8.1: ‘It pleased God... to choose and ordain the Lord Jesus, his only-begotten Son, to be the Mediator between God and man.’ Heidelberg Q.30 rejects looking elsewhere for help, calling those who do ‘in fact deny the only Saviour and Redeemer Jesus’ even while claiming to honor him”

methodist · United Methodist Articles of Religion, Article XIV, Of Purgatory (umc.org) · affirms · verified

“UM Article XIV: ‘Invocation of saints, is a fond thing, vainly invented, and grounded upon no warrant of Scripture, but repugnant to the Word of God.’ Direct adoption of Anglican Article XXII”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession of Faith 1632; the Schleithem Confession (silent on this specifically); broader Anabaptist practice prays only through Christ · affirms · unverified

“Dordrecht and historic Anabaptist practice direct all prayer to God through Christ alone. The Schleithem Confession does not explicitly address invocation of saints but treats Christ as the sole head of the church through whom all access to God is mediated”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, Truth 4 (Salvation of Man) and Truth 5 (The Ordinances of the Church) · affirms · unverified

“AG Truth 4: ‘Man’s only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ the Son of God.’ Salvation by faith in Christ alone; no provision for invocation of saints or alternate mediators in the Pentecostal doctrinal statement”

eastern_orthodox · OCA, The Orthodox Faith, on the Communion of Saints and Christ as High Priest (oca.org) · complicates · unverified

“Orthodox: Christ is the unique high priest and mediator of the new covenant. The intercession of the saints and the Theotokos is treated as horizontal communion among the members of Christ's body, by analogy to asking a living believer to pray; not as parallel covenantal mediation”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_timothy/2-5.htm

“1 Tim 2:5 heis gar theos heis kai mesites theou kai anthropon anthropos Christos Iesous. The numeric adjective heis doubled (one God, one mediator) with mesites G3316 identifies Christ as the single covenant go-between”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/14-6.htm>

“John 14:6 oudeis erchetai pros ton Patera ei me di emou. oudeis G3762 plus ei me G1487+G3361, the strongest Greek construction for absolute exclusion. Christ as exclusive channel to the Father”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/4-12.htm>

“Acts 4:12 three negations (ouk, oudeni, oude) plus heteron G2087 (other in kind). Lexically the strongest exclusive-name statement in Acts: no other name under heaven by which we must be saved”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/3316.htm>

“mesites G3316 occurs six times in the NT. Five (1 Tim 2:5, Heb 8:6, 9:15, 12:24, with the lone exception being Gal 3:19-20 referring to Moses) identify Christ as the mediator of the new covenant. Numeric pattern unambiguous”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/3875.htm>

“parakletos G3875 occurs five times: four of the Spirit (John 14:16, 14:26, 15:26, 16:7) and one of Christ (1 John 2:1). Advocacy is shared between Christ and the Spirit; neither is a created intermediary”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/7-25.htm>

“Heb 7:25 pantote zon eis to entunchanein hyper auton. Continuous present infinitive of intercession, grounded in Christ's indestructible life. Mediation is permanent priestly office, not one-time act”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_john/2-1.htm

“1 John 2:1 parakleton echomen pros ton Patera Iesoun Christon dikaion. Christ as advocate with the Father in courtroom-legal terms. dikaios G1342 establishes his moral standing to plead”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/8-34.htm>

“Rom 8:34 four-fold ground: died, raised, seated at right hand, presently interceding. Present indicative entunchanei makes the intercession ongoing”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/galatians/3-19.htm>

“Gal 3:19-20 mesites G3316 of Moses at Sinai. Paul's rhetorical point: mediated law inferior to direct Abrahamic promise. Christ as new-covenant Mediator replaces Moses as old-covenant mediator”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/8-26.htm>

“Rom 8:26 hyperentunchano G5241. The Spirit intercedes with wordless groanings. Same root as entunchano. Intercession-as-action shared by Christ and the Spirit; covenant-mediation reserved for Christ”

supports · category: patristic_archive · <https://ccel.org/ccel/schaff/npnf102/npnf102.iv.IX.15.html>

“Augustine City of God 9.15: 'we need not many but one Mediator, the uncreated Word of God, by whom all things were made, and in partaking of whom we are blessed.' Numeric exclusivity of Christ's mediation”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg XXI: 'Scripture teaches not the invocation of saints or to ask help of saints, since it sets before us the one Christ as the Mediator, Propitiation, High Priest, and Intercessor'”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“UM Article XIV: 'Invocation of saints, is a fond thing, vainly invented, and grounded upon no warrant of Scripture, but repugnant to the Word of God'”

nuance · category: magisterial · <https://www.vatican.va/archive/ccc/index.htm>

“CCC 970: 'Mary's function as mother of men in no way obscures or diminishes this unique mediation of Christ, but rather shows its power.' CCC 969 names Mary Advocate, Helper, Benefactress, Mediatrix as subordinate participation”

nuance · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith>

“OCA: Christ as the unique high priest and mediator of the new covenant. Intercession of the Theotokos and saints framed as communion of the body of Christ, not parallel mediation”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- confession-tradition-divergence